

ChatGPT ▾

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What does ecovadis do?

Fast answer

” Ask ChatGPT

EcoVadis is a company that provides **sustainability ratings for businesses**, mainly focused on how well companies manage environmental, social, and ethical risks.

In practical terms, it does a few key things:

- **Rates companies' sustainability performance**

It evaluates businesses on areas like:

- Environmental impact (e.g., carbon emissions, energy use)
- Labor & human rights
- Ethics (e.g., anti-corruption)
- Sustainable procurement

- **Supplies scorecards and benchmarks**

Companies receive a score and detailed feedback, which they can compare against peers and use to improve.

- **Helps large companies assess suppliers**

Many big organizations use EcoVadis to evaluate the sustainability of their **supply chains**, making it easier to choose responsible vendors.

- **Supports ESG and compliance efforts**

The ratings help companies meet ESG goals, regulatory expectations, and investor demands.

So, think of EcoVadis as a **third-party sustainability "credit rating agency" for companies**, widely used in global supply chains to measure and improve responsible business practices.

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I want to make a tool. What differentaiation can i do from exovadis
and how should my business model look like

If you build “another EcoVadis,” you’ll struggle. EcoVadis already owns the **scorecard + compliance + supply chain rating** space.

The smarter move is to **attack their weaknesses**, not replicate their strengths.

Where EcoVadis is weak (your entry points)

1. Static, backward-looking

- Annual or periodic assessments
- Heavy on documentation, light on real-time performance

👉 Opportunity: **Live, always-on intelligence**

2. Compliance-heavy, not decision-oriented

- Produces scores, not actions
- Doesn’t tell you *what to do Monday morning*

👉 Opportunity: **Action engine, not just scoring**

3. Painful UX + manual effort

- Long questionnaires
- Heavy documentation burden

👉 Opportunity: **AI-first automation**

4. Weak linkage to financial impact

- ESG score ≠ ROI clarity

👉 Opportunity: **Tie sustainability → cost savings, revenue, risk**

5. Supplier visibility is shallow

- Relies heavily on self-reported supplier data

👉 Opportunity: **Independent, data-rich supplier intelligence**

High-impact differentiated product ideas

1. “Real-Time ESG Operating System” (Most powerful)

Positioning:

Not a rating tool. A **live sustainability command center**

What it does:

- Integrates with:
 - ERP (SAP, Oracle)
 - IoT sensors (energy, emissions)
 - Procurement systems
- Tracks real-time:
 - Emissions
 - Energy consumption

- Supplier risk
- Gives:
 - Alerts ("Plant X exceeded emissions threshold today")
 - Recommendations ("Switch supplier → save 12% cost + reduce emissions 18%")

Killer differentiation:

👉 Moves from reporting → operating system

2. AI "Sustainability Copilot" (Huge wow factor)

Positioning:

ChatGPT for ESG teams

What it does:

- Auto-fills EcoVadis/CDP/GRI questionnaires
- Generates policies, reports, audit docs
- Suggests improvements based on gaps

Example:

"How do I improve my score from 62 → 75?"
→ AI gives a **step-by-step execution roadmap**

Killer differentiation:

👉 Reduces 80% manual effort

3. Supplier Intelligence Graph (B2B goldmine)

Positioning:

"Bloomberg for supply chain sustainability"

What it does:

- Builds a **live risk profile** of suppliers using:
 - News
 - Trade data
 - ESG violations
 - Financial signals
- No reliance on supplier self-reporting

Killer differentiation:

👉 Independent truth vs declared truth

4. ESG → Profit Engine (Board-level hook)

Positioning:

"Make sustainability measurable in dollars"

What it does:

- Quantifies:
 - Cost savings from energy optimization
 - Revenue from green premiums
 - Risk reduction (regulatory, supply chain)
- Creates CFO-ready dashboards

Killer differentiation:

👉 Finally answers: "What's the ROI of ESG?"

Ideal product strategy (what I'd actually do if I were you)

Given your background (construction + strategy), this is your unfair advantage:

👉 **Start with:**

"Sustainability Intelligence for Construction & Infra"

Why?

- High emissions industry
- Poor digitization
- Massive regulatory pressure
- Weak current solutions

MVP:

- Track:
 - Fuel usage (equipment)
 - Material carbon footprint
 - Vendor ESG risk
- Output:
 - Project-level ESG score
 - Cost + carbon optimization suggestions

👉 This is niche enough to win, big enough to scale

Business model (this is where most people mess up)**1. SaaS subscription (core)**

Tiered pricing:

- **SMEs:** \$5K–15K/year
- **Mid-market:** \$20K–75K/year
- **Enterprise:** \$100K–500K/year

Charge based on:

- Number of suppliers
 - Data integrations
 - Sites/projects tracked
-

2. Supplier network monetization (scalable goldmine)

Like EcoVadis:

- Anchor client invites suppliers
- Suppliers pay to:
 - Get rated
 - Benchmark
 - Improve

👉 This creates **network effects**

3. Premium modules

Add-ons:

- Real-time monitoring
 - AI copilot
 - Regulatory reporting automation
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4. Data monetization (long-term moat)

- Benchmark datasets
 - Industry reports
 - API access for investors / consultants
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5. Consulting + implementation (early revenue)

Initially:

- Help companies improve scores
 - Charge \$20K–100K per project
- 👉 Funds product build + gives insights
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Your real differentiation (the one-liner)

If EcoVadis is:

“We rate your past sustainability performance”

You should be:

“We improve your future sustainability performance in real time—and prove ROI.”

What investors will like (important for your PE angle)

- Large ESG + regulatory tailwind
 - Recurring SaaS revenue
 - Network effects (supplier ecosystem)
 - Data moat over time
 - Clear expansion from niche → global
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If you want, I can go one level deeper and:

- ↳ Design your **exact MVP screens / UX**
- ↳ Define **first 10 customers strategy in Singapore/India**
- Or ↳ simulate a **pitch to a PE/VC firm**

That's where this idea becomes fundable, not just interesting.